MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

QA Automation Engineer | CI/CD & Platform Engineering
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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer with 7 years of experience, including hands-on ownership of CI/CD pipelines and test infrastructure for three product teams. Built GitLab CI workflows and Helm-based ephemeral environments on a shared Kubernetes cluster; personal projects include a k3s GitOps homelab and Terraform-provisioned Hetzner VPS infrastructure. Seeking to move into a DevOps or platform engineering role.

SKILLS

Infrastructure and delivery: GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Kubernetes (namespace-level access at work; k3s in a personal project)
Infrastructure as code and cloud learning: Terraform (personal Hetzner VPS project), Ansible (basic), AWS (personal learning: EC2 and S3 basics)
Observability: Prometheus, Grafana, Loki; Grafana dashboards for test metrics
Scripting and data: Python, Bash, SQL, PostgreSQL
Systems and testing: Linux, Git, pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman, Java (test code)

EXPERIENCE

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure) | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw
2021–Present

- Own GitLab CI pipelines for three product teams (about 25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages, and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes by parallelising test jobs, caching dependencies and separating end-to-end tests into their own stage; monthly CI runner cost fell by about 30%.
- Built merge-request ephemeral test environments using Docker Compose and later Helm charts on the company's shared Kubernetes cluster; environments include the application, PostgreSQL and seeded data and are automatically destroyed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of about 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling for PostgreSQL test-data seeding and an internal guide to the CI system used in onboarding.

QA Engineer | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw *2019–2021*

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects using manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Selenium and Java automated regression suite for the largest client project and configured Jenkins jobs for nightly runs.

Customer Support Specialist (2nd line) | Brightmill Software House *2018–2019*

- Investigated customer issues in logs and databases and reproduced bugs for developers.

Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps | Personal *2024–2025*

- Built a three-node Raspberry Pi 5 k3s cluster and deployed applications from a Git repository using Argo CD.
- Added Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for monitoring, Traefik ingress and cert-manager for TLS; provisioned infrastructure for a small Hetzner VPS with Terraform.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Merge-Request Ephemeral Environments | Odrava Health *2023–2024*

- Implemented short-lived environments for each merge request, deployed via Helm to the shared Kubernetes cluster from GitLab CI, with automatic cleanup after merge or 48 hours of inactivity.
- Enabled QA and product teams to review features before merge and run end-to-end tests against the environments.

CI Pipeline Speed-up | Odrava Health *2022*

- Profiled pipelines for three teams, parallelised test jobs, added dependency caching and split end-to-end tests into a separate stage.
- Reduced average pipeline time from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner cost by about 30%.

EDUCATION

BEng Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

CERTIFICATION AND DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) preparation; exam booked for January 2027 (not yet certified)

LANGUAGES

Polish (native), English (C1), German (A2)